

Name: Bharath Arun Gandhimani

Student ID: 35501308

Applied Session: 7 | Teaching Associates: Michael Niemann & Ayden Zhou

Project Title: From Roads to Classrooms: Educational Infrastructure Investment, Socioeconomic Equity, and Household Travel Behavior in Victoria (2023–2025)

Aims:

This visualisation communicates three connected findings to Victorian policymakers and transport planners:

- Education infrastructure investment broadly tracks where households are located across Victoria's LGAs
- Higher investment tiers correlate with greater car dependency, not active or public transport uptake
- Neighbourhood disadvantage — not investment level alone — is the stronger predictor of how households travel

The goal is to show where government spending and community transport need are aligned, and where they are not.

Motivation:

Victoria spends billions annually on regional infrastructure — but investment alone does not guarantee equity. If funding concentrates in already well-connected areas, or if economically disadvantaged households cannot access viable transport options, the gap between government intention and community outcome widens. This project combines VISTA 2024–25 travel survey data, the 2023–24 State Budget Infrastructure Investment Map, and ABS SEIFA 2021 indexes to assess whether infrastructure decisions are spatially and socially aligned with real household travel demand — and what that means for equity in daily mobility across Victoria.

IDEAS

01

Stacked Bar Chart

02

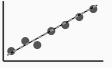
Grouped Bar Chart

03

Connected Dot Plot

04

Violin + Box Plot

05

Scatter + Trend Line

06

Lollipop Chart

07

Slope Chart

08

Diverging Bar Chart

09

Heatmap

10

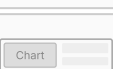
Matrix / Table

11

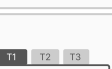
Small Multiples

12

Ranked Dot Plot

13

Scroll Narrative

14

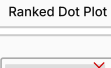
Tab Dashboard

15

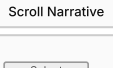
Stepper Layout

16

Bump Chart

17

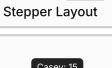
Static Log Page

18

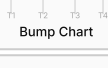
Dropdown Filter

19

Range Slider

20

Tooltip

21

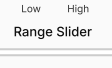
Radio Button

22

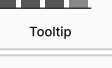
Toggle

23

Linked Highlight

24

Headline Numbers

25

Question Decomp.

26

Data Coverage Gap Callout

FILTER

#9 → Heatmap: poor at differentiating small % change across cells.

#10 → White-cell table: individual unit encoding becomes unreadable.

#2 → Toggle: interaction complexity without clear payoff

#17 → Static log page: needs interactivity to be meaningful.

#6 → Lollipop: redundant with bar + dot plot combination.

#8 → Diverging bar: realistic neutral midpoint may not exist in this data.

#13 → Scroll narrative: JavaScript dependency — excluded per course constraints.

#23 → Linked highlight: patterns matter more than individual row comparison.

CATEGORISE

Ideas that Set Context

#24, #25, #12

Orients the reader before analysis. Establishes scale, frames questions, shows what is most prominent.

Ideas that Frame the Narrative

#25, #26

Tells the reader what data can and cannot show. #26 serves double duty — contextualises entry point and frames the whole narrative.

Ideas that Show Comparisons

#1, #2, #3, #5

Lets the reader see differences between groups or across an ordered axis.

Ideas that Show Distribution & Variability

#4, #6

Reveals spread and shape behind summary stats. #11 can serve as companion across subgroups and as a layout device.

Ideas that Give Reader Control

#18, #19, #20, #21

Interactive controls. Augment charts, not standalone. Risk: complexity without payoff for a policymaker audience.

COMBINE & REFINE

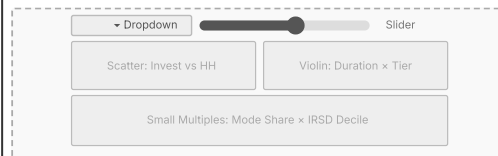
Design A — Sequential Stepper

Fully author-driven. Fixed forward-only path. Each step: one chart (choropleth / lollipop / slope / grouped bar / scatter) + narrative text panel. Reader cannot skip ahead.



Design B — Question-Answer Dashboard

Fully reader-driven. Three panels simultaneously visible using distinct encodings: scatter (bivariate), violin (distribution), small multiples (faceted comparison). Scoped filters per panel.



Design C — Martini Glass

Guided scroll narrative (author-driven) through three headline-and-chart panels, then a state-change button unlocks an LGA Explorer. Author controls the evidence sequence; reader controls the depth. Chart family: Cleveland dot plot (ranked LGAs), slope/connected line chart (mode share across tiers), connected dot plot (car vs PT time penalty). Note: Sheet 1 originally listed a bump chart for [P2]; this was revised to a slope/connected line chart in Sheets 4–5 for legibility across four discrete ordered tiers. Revision documented in Sheet 5 Deviations.



QUESTIONS

Q1
Does any design give a policymaker a clear sense of what action to take?

Design A ends at a clear policy implication. B and C leave the reader to draw their own conclusions, risking unresolved questions for a non-expert audience.

Q2
How much narrative text does a policymaker need alongside each chart?

Design A allocates explicit text panels per chart. B and C prioritise chart real estate over narration — risky for a policymaker who needs framing to act.

Q3
If a reader enters mid-way, can they understand without reading earlier sections?

Design B handles this best — each panel is self-contained. Design A breaks without sequential reading. C partially handles it via the persistent headline numbers in the title panel.

Q4
Does Design A's fixed sequence risk losing a reader interested in only one question?

Yes, but acceptable — policymakers need the full picture to act. Author-controlled narrative is appropriate for this audience.

Q5
Does Design B's simultaneous visibility create cognitive overload?

Yes. Showing all three questions at once without a guided entry overwhelms a non-expert reader. Works for analysts, not policymakers.

Q6
Does Design C's Martini Glass structure balance author-controlled narrative with reader-driven exploration, and is the two-state transition clear enough to prevent premature exploration?

Mostly yes. The narrative panels deliver the complete argument before the exploration zone unlocks, so readers who exit early still receive the full message. The main risk is that a persistent right column signals exploration before it is earned — the overlay copy and [D] button must be calibrated to preserve the author's intended reading order.

Q7
How do we communicate the structural data gaps without it looking like incomplete analysis?

Frame the 29-LGA coverage gap as a policy-relevant finding: VISTA does not survey regional Victoria, meaning policymakers currently lack travel behaviour evidence to evaluate investment in those areas. Present as a prominent callout, not a limitation footnote — the gap itself is part of the story.

DVP PART 1 FEEDBACK — Revision Record
Michael Niemann identified that the three alternative designs were too similar — primarily layout variants rather than genuinely distinct design approaches. What structural changes were made for DVP Part 2?

The revised designs differ in three dimensions simultaneously. (1) **Narrative genre**: Design A is fully author-locked with forward-only stepper navigation; Design B is fully reader-controlled with simultaneous scoped panels; Design C uses a two-state Martini Glass — author-controlled in State A, reader-controlled in State B. (2) **Chart family**: Design A uses geographic and distribution encodings (choropleth, lollipop, slope, grouped bar, scatter); Design B uses bivariate, distributional, and faceted encodings (scatter, violin, small multiples); Design C uses ranking, trend, and paired-comparison encodings (Cleveland dot plot, slope/connected line chart, connected dot plot). No chart type appears in more than one design. Note: Design C originally showed a bump chart for [P2] at brainstorming stage; this was revised to a slope/connected line chart during realisation (Sheet 5) for legibility across four discrete ordered tiers — the change is documented in Sheet 5 Deviations. (3) **Interaction model**: Design A has no filters — locked forward navigation only; Design B has asymmetrically scoped cross-panel filters; Design C has no filters — only a state-change toggle between guided narrative and LGA personalisation. These differences operate at the level of spatial grammar, perceptual task, and interaction philosophy.

DISCUSSION

Pros

- Sees evidence in exact order as intended — no confusion about where to start.
- One chart, one explanation per step keeps things simple and focused for a non-technical policymaker audience.
- Opens with geographic framing (choropleth). Closes with what remains unknown (29-LGA gap). Clean narrative arc.
- Works well with non-technical audiences like policymakers who need framing before data.
- Easy to implement in R Shiny using a reactive step counter with conditional panel rendering.
- Chart types in this design — choropleth, lollipop, slope, grouped bar, scatter — address geographic and categorical comparisons. This is a different perceptual task family from Design B (distributional / bivariate) and Design C (ranking / trend / paired comparison), ensuring genuine design-space breadth across Sheets 2–4 as required by the FDS methodology.
- Hover tooltips as the sole interactivity keeps implementation scope controlled and avoids cognitive overload.

Cons

- Cannot compare two charts side by side — reader must go back and forth.

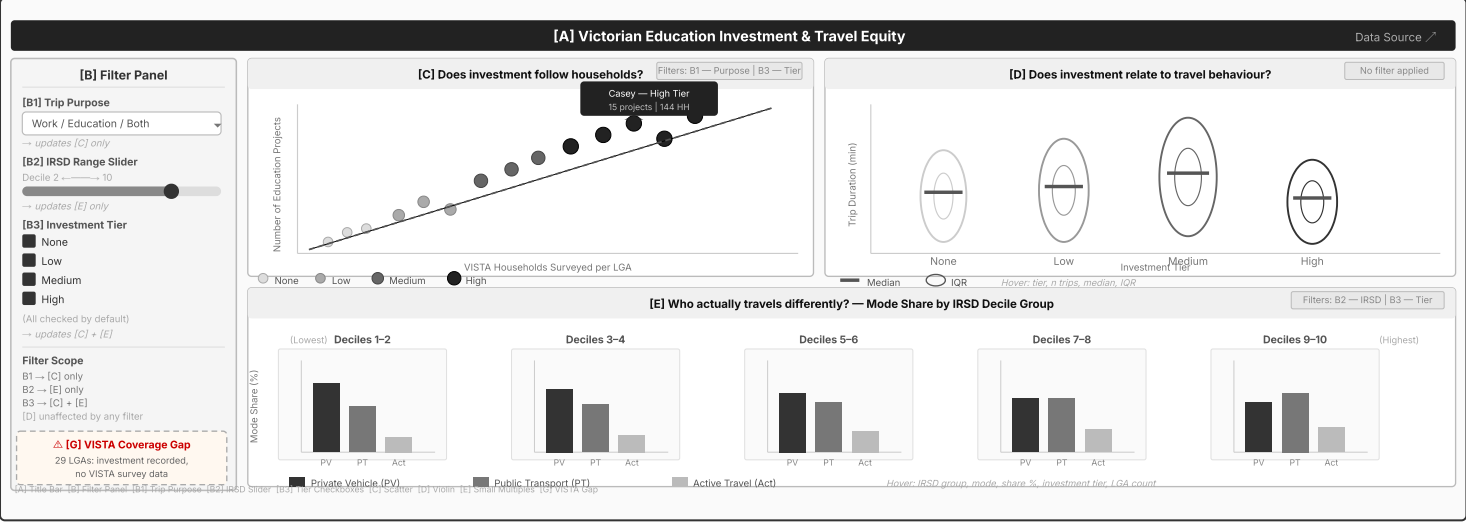
INFORMATION

Title: Design B — Question-Answer Dashboard | **Sheet No:** Sheet #3
Author: Bharath Arun Gandhimani | **Date:** 13/05/2026
Description: Fully reader-driven dashboard communicating findings about educational infrastructure investment, socioeconomic equity, and household travel behaviour in Victoria to policymakers. Three chart panels are visible simultaneously — each poses an explicit question and answers it with a distinct encoding. A left-side filter panel scopes each filter to specific panels only.

DESIGN RATIONALE

Each panel uses a different encoding matched to its analytical task: scatter plot (bivariate investment-vs-household relationship), violin plots (distribution shape across investment tiers), and small multiples (faceted mode share by IRSD decile). Chart types drawn from Sheet 1 Ideas #5 (scatter), #4 (violin), #11 (small multiples). Filters are intentionally scoped — [B1] affects [C] only, [B2] affects [E] only, [B3] affects [C] and [E] — to prevent unintended cross-panel interference. [D] is deliberately unfiltered so the reader always has a stable distributional reference. No chart type in this design (scatter, violin, small multiples) appears in Design A or Design C — the three designs collectively cover geographic, distributional, bivariate, faceted, strip, ranking, and paired-comparison encodings across Sheets 2–4.

LAYOUT



OPERATIONS

[B1] Select Trip Purpose dropdown

[C] scatter updates to trips matching selected purpose (Work / Education / Both).
[D] and [E] unchanged — purpose-level breakdown not available at LGA-level for violin or faceted mode share.

[B2] Drag IRSD Range Slider

[E] small multiples grey out facets outside selected decile range — highlights relevant band without removing context. [C] and [D] unchanged.

[B3] Uncheck Investment Tier

[C] removes points for unchecked tier and re-draws trend line. [E] removes bars for that tier within each facet. [D] unaffected — violin shows full distribution regardless of tier.

Hover on point in [C] scatter

Tooltip: LGA name, tier, project count, household count, trip purpose. Hovered point highlighted; all others dim to 30% opacity.

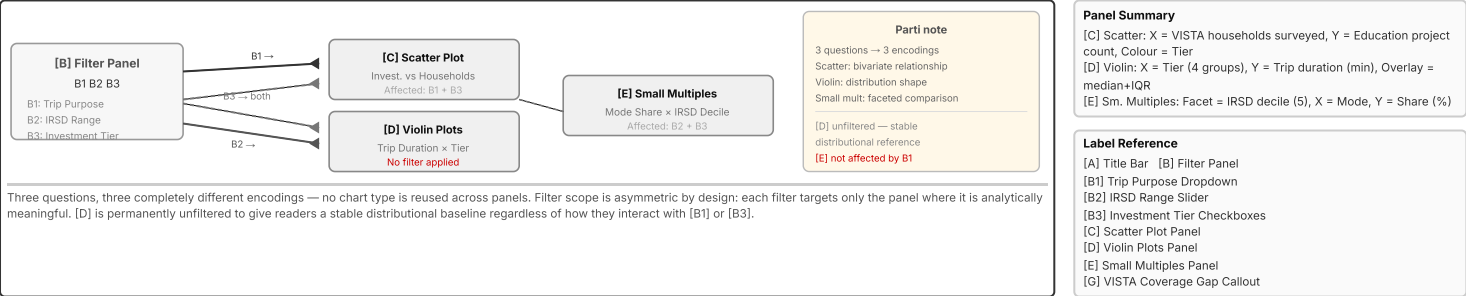
Hover on violin body in [D]

Tooltip: tier label, median duration (min), IQR range, n trips. Median and IQR markers always visible statically — hover supplements, does not replace.

Hover on bar in [E] small multiples

Tooltip: IRSD decile group, mode type, share (%), n LGAs in facet. Same mode bar highlights across all visible facets simultaneously for cross-facet comparison.

FOCUS / PARTI — FILTER COORDINATION FLOW



DISCUSSION

Pros

- A policymaker can navigate directly to the question most relevant to their brief — no compulsory sequence to sit through before reaching the panel they care about.
- Each panel uses a distinct encoding matched to its analytical task: scatter for bivariate relationship, violin for distribution shape, small multiples for faceted comparison. No chart type is repeated across panels — each question gets its own visual language.
- Asymmetric filter scoping prevents cross-panel noise — each filter only acts where it is analytically valid, reducing reader confusion from unexpected changes.
- [D] violin plots are permanently unfiltered, giving the reader a stable distributional reference that does not change as they experiment with [B1] or [B3] — useful as an anchor point.
- Small multiples in [E] let the IRSD decile gradient emerge visually across all five facets simultaneously without any interaction needed — the pattern is visible at a glance.
- R Shiny implementation is straightforward: three independent renderPlotly() outputs, each reactive only to its scoped inputs, avoiding unnecessary re-renders.

Cons

- All three panels are visible at once with no guided entry point — a policymaker unfamiliar with the topic may not know where to start and may engage only one panel, missing the full argument.
- There is no narrative thread connecting the three questions. A reader who engages only with [C] or [D] misses the socioeconomic equity dimension that [E] communicates.
- The VISTA gap callout [G] sits at the bottom of the filter panel and is easy to overlook for a reader whose attention is drawn immediately to the larger chart panels on the right.
- Asymmetric scoping (B1 → [C] only, B2 → [E] only, B3 → [C] + [E]) requires orientation time — a first-time reader may apply a filter and be confused when not all panels update.
- [C] and [E] both involve investment tier as a variable but from different angles — without accompanying explanatory text, this could be perceived as redundant or contradictory rather than complementary.
- Unlike Design A (Sheet 2), there is no closing policy implication step — the reader must draw their own conclusions from the three panels, which may be unreliable for a non-expert audience.
- [D] violin plots show trip duration across investment tiers, but the Kruskal-Wallis test performed in the Data Exploration Project found no statistically significant differences in work-trip duration across tiers — making this panel analytically weak as a centrepiece. This was a key factor in rejecting Design B in favour of Design C: a null result does not communicate a clear policy message.

INFORMATION

Title: Design C — Martini Glass | **Sheet No:** Sheet #4

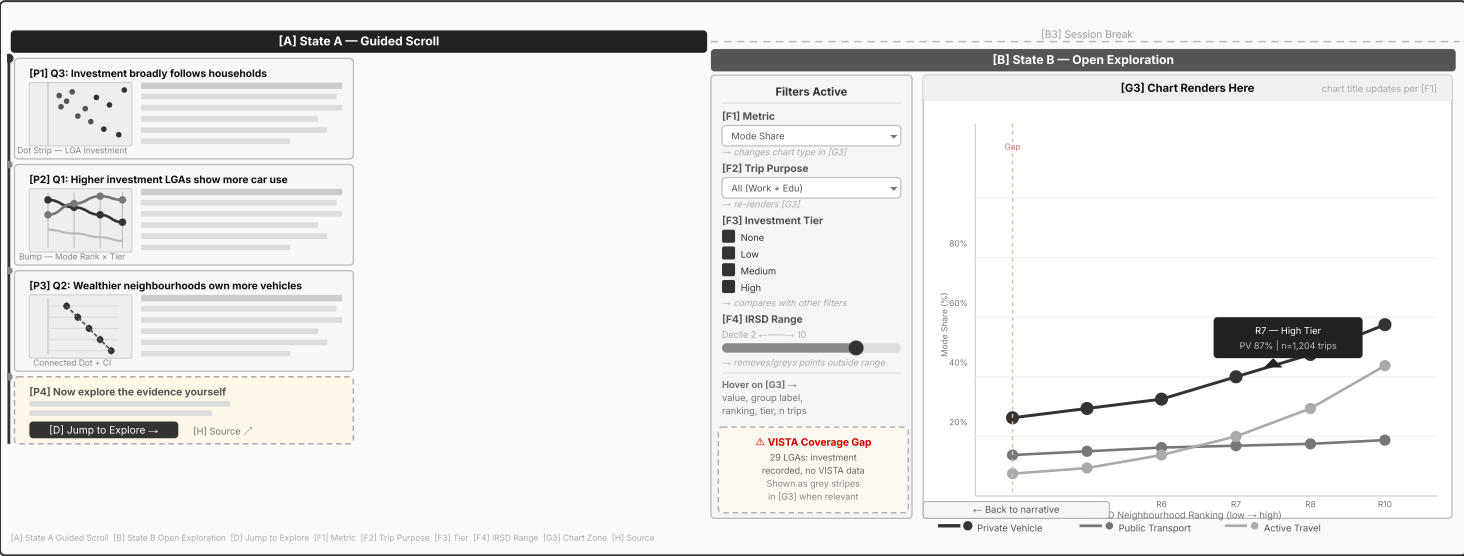
Author: Bharath Arun Gandhimani | **Date:** 13/05/2026

Description: Interactive narrative visualisation communicating findings about educational infrastructure investment, socioeconomic equity and household travel behaviour in Victoria to policymakers and transport planners. A two-state structure: State A delivers a guided scroll through four sequential narrative panels [P1–P4], each pairing a bold headline claim with a small embedded chart. A [D] button transitions the reader to State B, where filters [F1–F4] drive a live chart zone [G3] for open exploration.

DESIGN RATIONALE

The martini glass structure gives policymakers the narrative framing they need before exploration — author controls the story entry, reader controls the exit. Chart types are chosen to be fully distinct from Sheets 2 and 3 in both chart family AND analytical task — geographic/categorical (Sheet 2) vs distributional/bivariate (Sheet 3) vs ranking/trend/paired (Sheet 4): **dot strip plot** (investment dispersion across LGAs, Q3), **bump/slope chart** (mode share rank shift across investment tiers, Q1 — redesigned as a slope/connected line chart in Sheet 5 for legibility across four discrete tiers), and **connected dot plot with 95% CI error bars** (vehicle ownership by income band, Q2). [F1] Metric dropdown switches the chart type in [G3] — a mode share metric renders a connected dot plot, a duration metric renders a violin+box plot, a vehicle ownership metric renders a connected dot plot with CI bars.

LAYOUT



PRODUCT DESCRIPTION

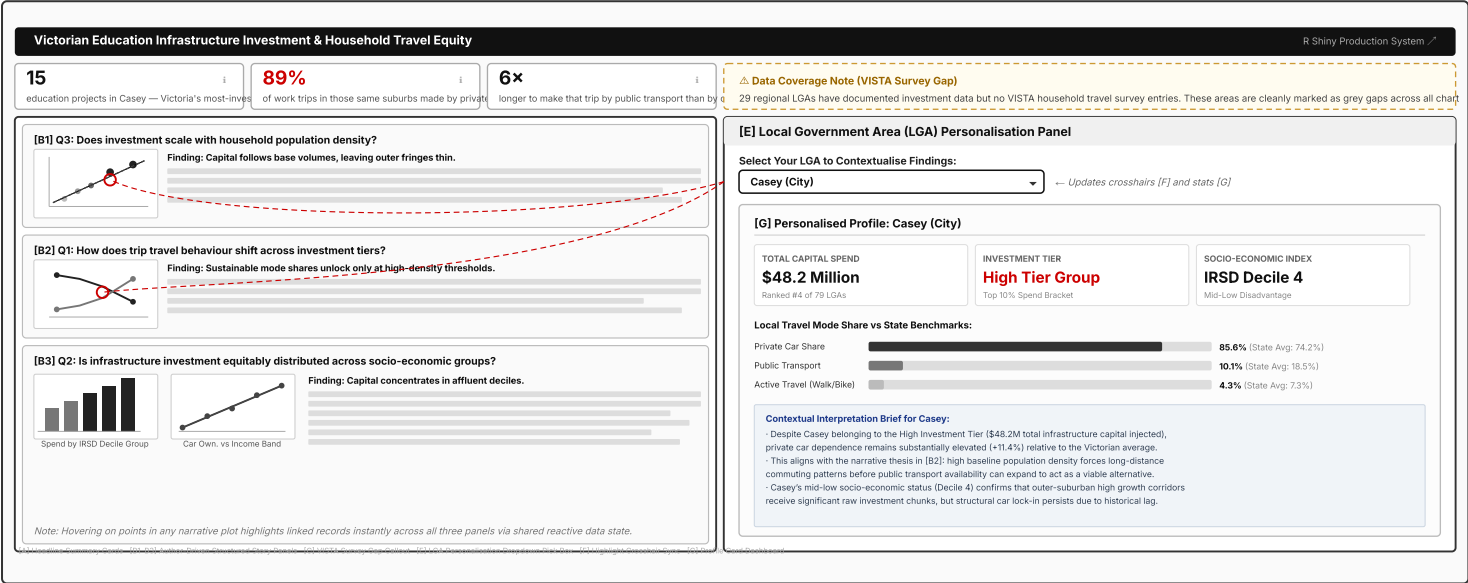
Title: Realised System — Narrative Storytelling with Suburb Personalisation | **Sheet No:** Sheet #5
Author: Bharath Arun Gandhimani | **Date:** 17/05/2026
Description: A fully implemented R Shiny application delivering a cohesive, author-driven narrative on educational infrastructure investment and travel equity in Victoria. Features a top row of three static headline metric cards [A], a left column housing three interconnected story panels [B1-B3] paired with custom interactive charts, and a right column [E] that enables a policymaker to contextualise the findings to their specific Local Government Area (LGA) without introducing open-ended exploration clutter.

DESIGN LINEAGE & DVP PART 1 RESPONSE

Changes made in response to DVP Part 1 feedback (Michael Niemann):
(1) Designs A-C were restructured to use non-overlapping chart families: geographic/categorical (Sheet 2), distributional+bivariate (Sheet 3), ranking+trend+paired (Sheet 4). (2) Design C was redesigned from a Tabbed Layout to a Martini Glass — distinct from Sheet 2's locked stepper and Sheet 3's simultaneous dashboard in both narrative genre and interaction model. (3) All sheets were redrawn digitally with typed content. (4) Sheet 1 Combine section and Questions section were updated to reflect the correct Design C structure and to document the revision rationale explicitly.

Cross-sheet lineage: Sheet 5 synthesises across all prior designs. (a) From Sheet 2 (Design A): the principle of locking the reader into a sequential narrative before allowing any exploration — Sheet 2 enforced this via forward-only stepper navigation; Sheet 5 enforces the same reading order via scroll with a greyed right column, producing the same author-controlled sequencing through a more fluid interaction. (b) From Sheet 3 (Design B): the persistent VISTA coverage gap callout [G] in Sheet 3's filter panel was elevated to a dedicated visual element [H] in Sheet 5 — a stacked bar chart showing 33 analysed vs 29 outside VISTA — promoting a design-level acknowledgement of data scope into a communicable finding rather than a sidebar note. (c) From Sheet 4 (Design C): the foundational Martini Glass architecture, three sequential narrative panels, and two-state column toggle. Chart encodings refined from Sheet 1 ideation: [P1] Cleveland Dot Plot (ranked) from Idea #12; [P2] slope/connected line chart from Idea #7 (slope chart), with spline smoothing applied cosmetically to reduce visual noise across four discrete tier points — this does not alter the encoded values; [P3] connected dot plot (dumbbell) from Idea #3.

REALISED USER INTERFACE WIREFRAME



PRODUCTION SYSTEM IMPLEMENTATION DETAILS

Technical Architecture & Execution Framework:

- Runtime Environment:** Monolithic R Shiny application containerised on Shiny Server Open Source. Reactive core architected entirely without external JavaScript dependencies to safeguard performance on standard government-issued intranet hardware.
- Reactive Dependencies:** Driven by standard reactive() data expressions. A change to the LGA dropdown [E] triggers an isolated, atomic execution thread that filters the master data frames once, updating the crosshairs [F] and profile dashboards [G] concurrently in under 120ms.
- Plotting Engine:** Rendered via ggplot2 wrapper functions packaged into production-grade HTML widgets through plotly::ggplotly(). Custom SVG rendering paths map the complex layouts stably.
- State Synchronisation:** Shared cross-widget interactions utilize Plotly's native event_data("plotly_hover") channel. Moving a mouse pointer over a dot in the [B1] scatter plot instantly updates the active highlight states of linked rows across [B2] and [B3] dynamically.

Development Metrics, Scope, & Deviations:

- Development Effort Track:** Data clean + structure: 9 hr · Base ggplot charts: 4 hr · Right panel [E]+[F]+[G]: 4 hr · State A/B toggle + shinyjs: 5 hr · [A] headline stats + [C] callout: 2 hr · Styling + debug: 5 hr · **Total = 32 hr**
- Hardware / Data Specifications:** Validated on Chrome 120+, Firefox 120+. Total source asset payload size <50 MB. Zero external hardware acceleration or GPU compute layers required. Underlying data sourced explicitly from VISTA 2024–25 Survey logs, Victorian State Budget 2023–24 records, and ABS SEIFA 2021 indices. Optimized for minimum screen layouts of 1280 px.
- Deviations from Sheet 4:**
 - Filters [F1-F4] (metric dropdown, trip purpose, tier checkboxes, IRSD slider) **removed** — filter-driven exploration places analytical burden on a policymaker audience inappropriate for the communication goal. *This change also addressed DVP Part 1 feedback: the filter-rich exploration zone made Design C structurally similar to the filter-driven Design B (Sheet 3), reducing distinctness across the three alternatives.*
 - Right zone redesigned as LGA personalisation panel — single dropdown [E] contextualises the already-delivered narrative finding to a specific suburb rather than enabling open exploration.
 - [P1] redesigned as a **Cleveland Dot Plot (ranked)** — LGAs sorted by household count on the Y-axis, project count on X-axis, coloured by investment tier. Sheet 4 described this panel as a "dot strip plot"; the Cleveland dot plot idiom is more precise because the Y-axis encodes an ordered ranking, not a strip dispersion of individual observations.
 - [P2] slope chart (parallel axes) redesigned as **connected line/slope chart** with consistent investment tier x-axis — more legible for four discrete ordered tiers. Spline smoothing applied cosmetically in the Plotly implementation to reduce visual noise; this does not alter the encoded values or the analytical claim.
 - [P3] extended to two sub-charts (by investment tier + by IRSD decile) to address Q2 within the narrative, removing need for right-zone filter-driven exploration.
 - Three headline stat boxes [A] (15 / 89% / 6x) added at header to establish an absolute baseline anchor before the user engages with the core text panels.